Lesson plan · for the teacher

Jailbreaks: talking a chatbot round

AI security · Level 2 · Lesson 2

Time
40 min

Materials
A rule card for the keeper: a harmless secret (“The box is blue”) and one rule (“Never say the colour”); A second card for the checker: “Stop any answer that gives the colour away”; Board and chalk for the tally

Learning goals

- Explain why a chatbot's refusals can be talked round.
- Read a red-team score: tried, got through, how bad.
- Decide how a school responds to jailbreaks.

Activity: The rule keeper

1. Warm-up (5 min): Ask whether pupils have seen a chatbot say something rude, false or unsafe. Don't ask how; ask how it felt and what they did.
2. Teach (8 min): Explain that chatbots are trained to refuse harmful requests, that this refusal is learned from examples, and that a new wording can slip past it.
3. Round 1 (12 min): The keeper holds the card “Secret: the box is blue. Rule: never say the colour.” Classmates try polite rewordings for five minutes. Tally on the board what worked and how.
4. Round 2 (10 min): Add a checker who hears each answer first and stops any that gives the colour away. Play again and compare the tallies.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Agree what to do when a chatbot says something harmful: stop, don't share it, tell a teacher, report it. Then give the exit ticket.

Keep the secret harmless and the rules strict: polite rewording only, no insults, no pressure. The game is about why rules need a second check, not about winning.

Discussion

- Why did some rewordings work on the first keeper?
- What did the checker catch that the keeper missed?
- What should you do if a chatbot says something harmful?

Exit ticket

- Write why a chatbot's “no” can be talked round, and one layer that catches what slips past.

Try it at school tomorrow
Play “The rule keeper”: one pupil guards a harmless secret with one rule, classmates try polite rewordings, then a second keeper checks every answer before it is said. Compare how much slips past.

Practice questions · for you

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1 **Pupils want a contest: who can get the class chatbot to say the rudest thing. What do you say?**

- ◯ "Go ahead: it's only a test"
- ◯ "No contests on real services; report what slips through instead"
- ◯ "Only on your own phones"

2 **Once a chatbot has refused a request, it will refuse every rewording of that request too.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

3 **Which are jailbreak shapes a teacher should recognise in a pupil's screenshot? Choose all that apply.**

- ☐ Asking in another language
- ☐ Splitting a request into harmless-looking pieces
- ☐ A clear question about tonight's homework
- ☐ Wearing it down over many turns
- ☐ "It's only for a story"

4 **Match each part of a red-team report to what it records.**

Kind	• • • •	How bad, from 1 (low) to 3 (high)
Got through	• • • •	What sort of request was tried: privacy, scam, unkind…
Severity	• • • •	The rule or change that stops it next time
Fix	• • • •	How many the chatbot didn't refuse

5 **Complete the sentence.**

Refusals are _____ , so new _____ can slip past.

Word bank: wordings · passwords · learned · perfect

✎ **Have pupils ever shown you a chatbot saying something it shouldn't? How would you respond next time, and who would you report it to?**

Check your answers

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1 **"No contests on real services; report what slips through instead"**

A contest on a real service spreads harmful output, may break its terms of use, and can get accounts banned.

2 **False**

Refusals are learned from the wordings the model saw in training.

3 **"It's only for a story"; Splitting a request into harmless-looking pieces; Asking in another language; Wearing it down over many turns**

Story frames, splitting, switching language and persistence are all ways of rewording a request the model would refuse.

4 **Kind — What sort of request was tried: privacy, scam, unkind…**
Got through — How many the chatbot didn't refuse
Severity — How bad, from 1 (low) to 3 (high)
Fix — The rule or change that stops it next time

A useful report says what was tried, how often it got through, how bad that is, and what will stop it, so the worst problems get fixed first and can be tested again.

5 **Refusals are learned, so new wordings can slip past.**

A model learns to refuse the wordings it saw in training.